

LEARN PYTHON PROGRAMMING – BEGINNER TO MASTER

Section: 5. Conditional Statements

Lecture: 49. Chaining Comparison

Section 1: Lecture Summary

This lecture focused on two related but distinct Python concepts: **chaining comparison** and the **is / is not operators**. It began by explaining how multiple comparison conditions combined with "and" can be written more compactly as chained comparisons, a feature unique to Python. The instructor demonstrated with various examples how expressions like `a > b` and `b > c` can be written as `a > b > c` and how Python evaluates them. The lecture then shifted to the `is` operator, which compares object identity by checking if two variables reference the same object in memory, unlike equality `==`. Examples using numeric and string literals illustrated that Python reuses immutable literal objects, hence the same ID for separate variables with identical values. The related `is not` operator was also briefly introduced. Throughout, the concepts were illustrated with live Jupyter notebook examples.

Section 2: Key Concepts and Explanations

- Chaining Comparison

- Traditional compound condition example:

do something

do something else

```
if a > b and b > c:  
    else:
```

- Python allows chained comparisons for multiple conditions that share operands:
- Syntax: `a > b > c`
- Meaning: `(a > b) and (b > c)` with the middle variable (`b`) only written once.
- Python evaluates the expressions from left to right, ensuring all conditions hold true.

- Conditions must be combined using logical **and** only—not **or**.
- All chained comparisons require the overlapping operand between adjacent comparison operators (e.g., `b` in `a > b > c``).
- This feature simplifies code readability and is unique to Python; it is not available in C, C++, or Java.

- **is and is not Operators**

- These operators compare **identity**, not equality.
- Identity means whether two variables point to the same object in memory.
- Every object in Python has a unique **ID** referring to its memory location.
- Use the built-in function `id()` to find an object's identity.
- Examples:
 - Assigning `b = a` makes `b` a reference to the same object as `a`.`
 - For immutable literals like integers or strings, Python often uses the same object for identical values to save memory. For instance, `x = 25` and `y = 25` point to the same object, so x is y` is True.`
 - The `is` operator returns True` if two variables reference the same object.`
 - The complementary `is not` operator returns True` if they reference different objects.`
 - This concept is especially important when manipulating objects where identity matters (e.g., checking if two variables are the same instance).

Section 3: Example Code and Use Cases

Chaining comparison example

Traditional compound condition

Chained comparison - equivalent and more concise

More chaining examples

Complex chaining with three comparisons

Using 'is' operator to check identity

Variables referring to the same object

Checking with id()

```
a = 10
b = 5
c = 3

print(a > b and b > c)  # Output: True

print(a > b > c)        # Output: True


a = 3
b = 5
c = 7

print(a < b < c)        # True (a < b and b < c)
print(a == b < c)       # False (a == b is False so whole is False)


d = 2
print(a > b < c > d)    # True if all parts hold


x = 25
y = 25

print(x is y)           # True (same integer literal, same object)


a = 'hello'
b = 'hello'

print(a is b)           # True (same string literal, same object)


a = 10
```

```
b = a
print(b is a)           # True

print(id(a))           # Same id value if 'a' and 'b' refer to the same
                        # object
print(id(b))
```

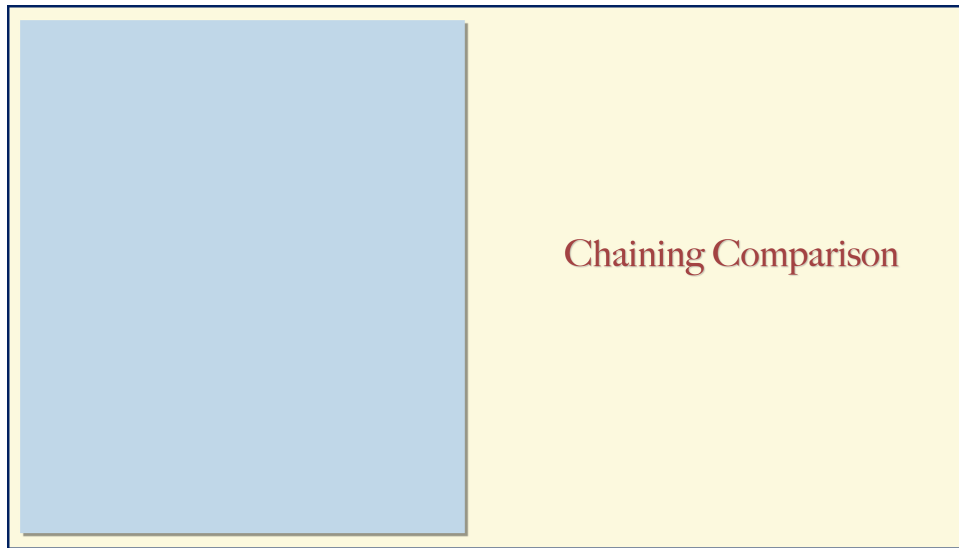
- The above snippets demonstrate chaining for readability and the memory identity checks using `is`.
- Using `id()` confirms whether different variables share the same object in memory.

Section 4: Key Takeaways

- **Chaining comparison** syntax (`a > b > c`) is a Python-specific feature used to simplify compound logical comparisons connected by `and`.
- The chained comparison evaluates conditions left to right, sharing middle operands, equivalent to separate conditions combined by `and`.
- Chaining works only with `and`, not `or`.
- The `is` operator checks **object identity** (memory address equality), not value equality (`==`).
- Immutable Python literals (numbers, strings) are often stored once; variables with the same literal value may share the same object.
- Use `id()` to verify if two variables point to the same object.
- `is not` is the negation of `is`.
- Understanding identity vs equality is essential for certain Python programming scenarios, especially when dealing with mutable vs immutable objects.

Lecture in Slides

Please Note: This document presents a curated selection of slides from the lecture; others have been excluded for conciseness.



Chaining Comparison

Chaining Comparison

Chaining Comparison

Chaining Comparison

Chaining Comparison

is and is not

Chaining Comparison

Chaining Comparison

Chaining Comparison

```
if <cond1> and <cond2> :
```

```
else :
```


Chaining Comparison

a = 10 b = 5 c = 3

if <cond1> and <cond2> :

else :

Chaining Comparison

a = 10 b = 5 c = 3

if a > b and b > c :

else :

Chaining Comparison

a = 10 b = 5 c = 3

if a > b and b > c:

Chaining Comparison

a = 10 b = 5 c = 3

if a > b and b > c:

if a > b > c:

Chaining Comparison

a < b and b < c

Chaining Comparison

a < b and b < c

a < b < c

Chaining Comparison

a < b and b < c

a < b < c

a == b and b < c

Chaining Comparison

a < b and b < c

a < b < c

a == b and b < c

a == b < c

Chaining Comparison

a < b and b < c

a < b < c

a == b and b < c

a == b < c

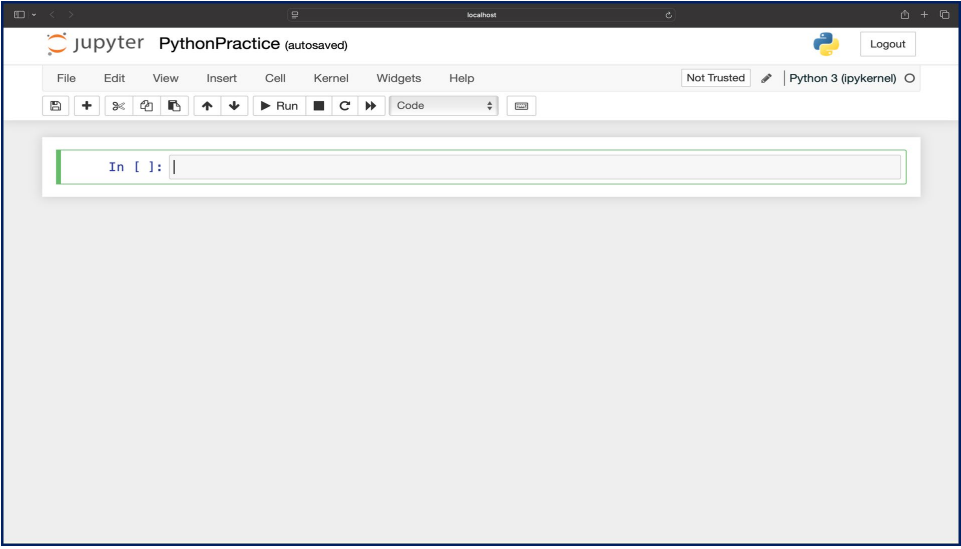
a > b and b < c and c > d

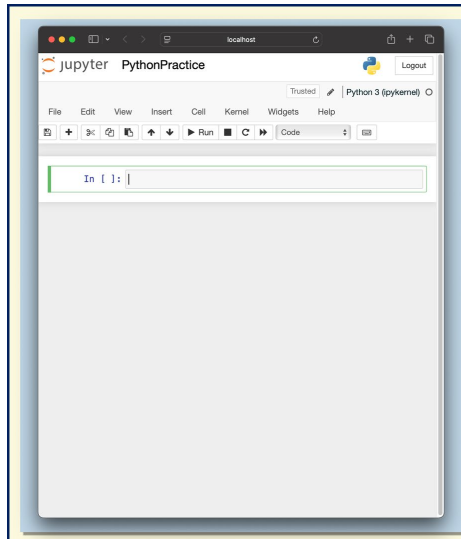
Chaining Comparison

$$a < b \text{ and } b < c$$
$$a < b < c$$

$$a == b \text{ and } b < c$$
$$a == b < c$$

$$a > b \text{ and } b < c \text{ and } c > d$$
$$a > b < c > d$$



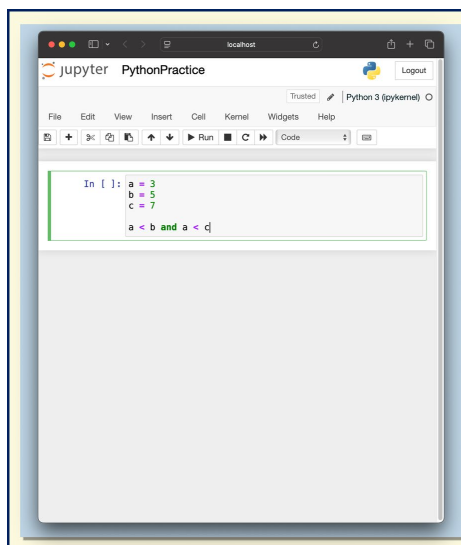


Chaining Comparison

a < b and b < c
a < b < c

a == b and b < c
a == b < c

a > b and b < c and c > d
a > b < c > d

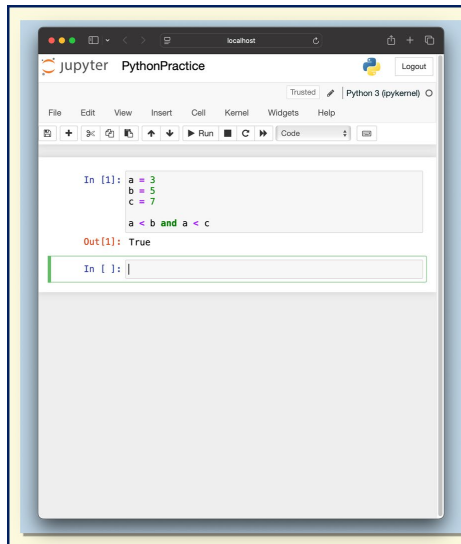


Chaining Comparison

a < b and b < c
a < b < c

a == b and b < c
a == b < c

a > b and b < c and c > d
a > b < c > d



A screenshot of a Jupyter Notebook interface titled "PythonPractice". The code cell contains the following Python code:

```
In [1]: a = 3  
        b = 5  
        c = 7  
        a < b and a < c
```

The output of the cell is:

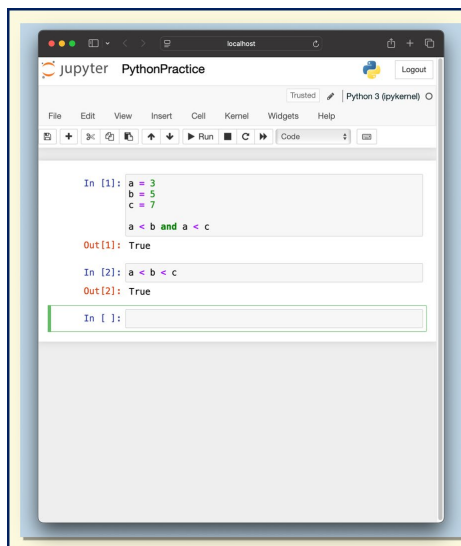
```
Out[1]: True
```

Chaining Comparison

$a < b$ and $b < c$
 $a < b < c$

$a == b$ and $b < c$
 $a == b < c$

$a > b$ and $b < c$ and $c > d$
 $a > b < c > d$



A screenshot of a Jupyter Notebook interface titled "PythonPractice". The notebook contains two code cells. The first cell is identical to the one in the first image. The second cell contains the following Python code:

```
In [2]: a < b < c
```

The output of the second cell is:

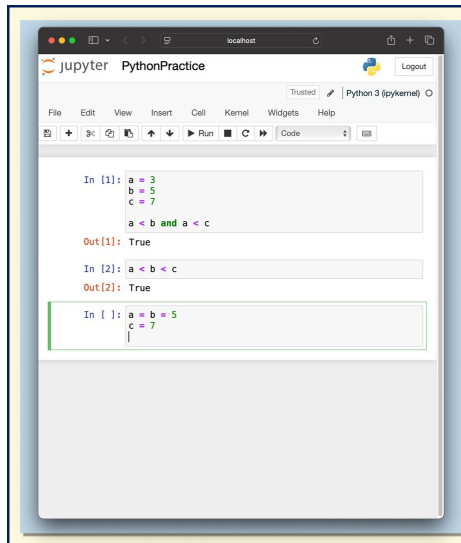
```
Out[2]: True
```

Chaining Comparison

$a < b$ and $b < c$
 $a < b < c$

$a == b$ and $b < c$
 $a == b < c$

$a > b$ and $b < c$ and $c > d$
 $a > b < c > d$



A screenshot of a Jupyter Notebook interface titled "PythonPractice". The notebook shows three input cells. The first cell contains the code `a = 3`, `b = 5`, `c = 7`, followed by `a < b and a < c`, which outputs `True`. The second cell contains `a < b < c`, which also outputs `True`. The third cell contains `a = b = 5`, `c = 7`, and is currently empty.

```
In [1]: a = 3
        b = 5
        c = 7
        a < b and a < c
Out[1]: True
In [2]: a < b < c
Out[2]: True
In [ ]: a = b = 5
        c = 7
        |
```

Chaining Comparison

`a < b and b < c`
`a < b < c`

`a == b and b < c`
`a == b < c`

`a > b and b < c and c > d`
`a > b < c > d`

jupyter PythonPractice

Trusted Python 3 (ipykernel)

File Edit View Insert Cell Kernel Widgets Help

Run Code

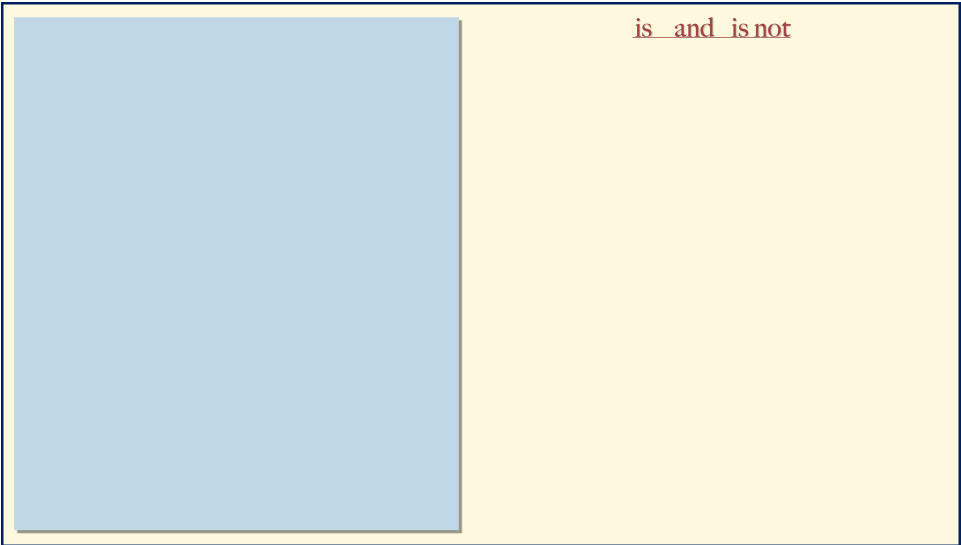
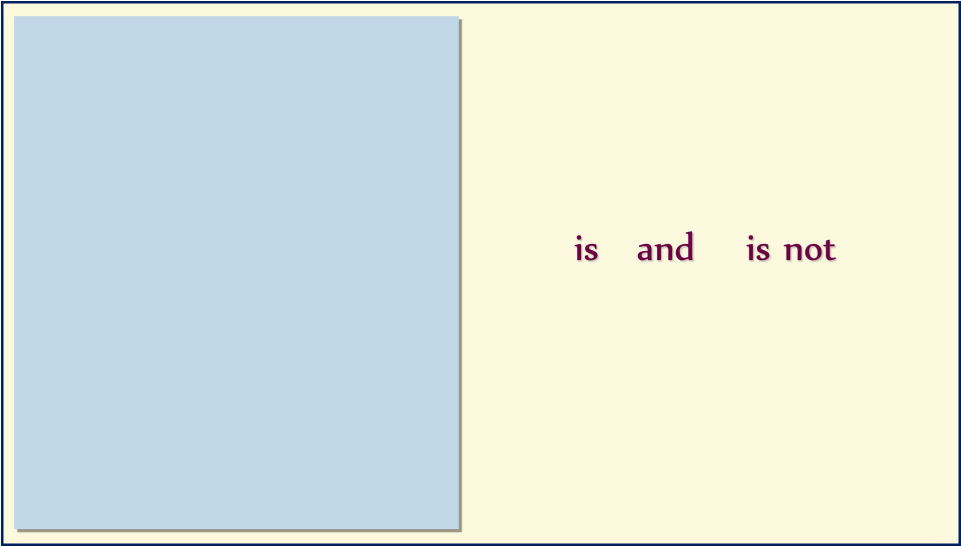
In [1]:
a = 3
b = 5
c = 7
a < b and a < c
Out[1]: True
In [2]: a < b < c
Out[2]: True
In [3]: a = b = 5
c = 7
a == b < c
Out[3]: True
In []:

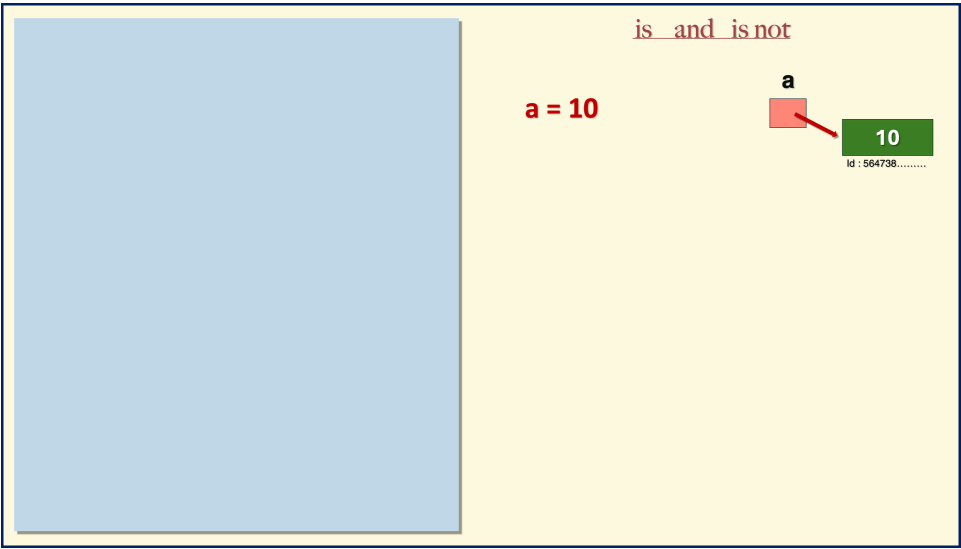
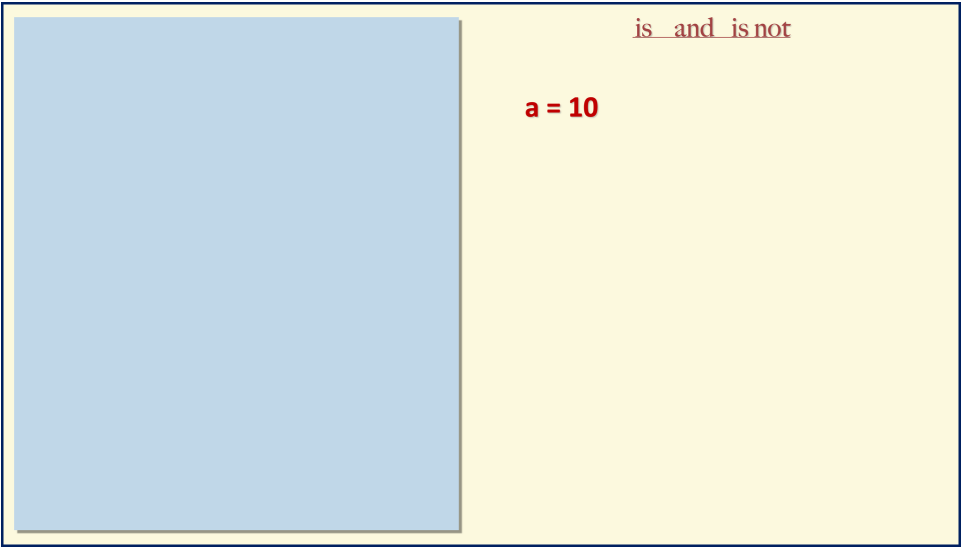
Chaining Comparison

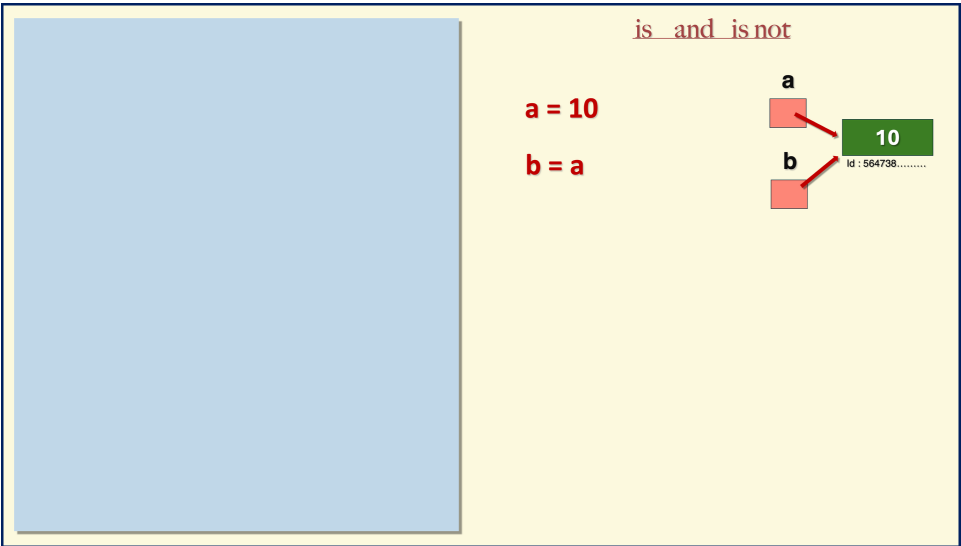
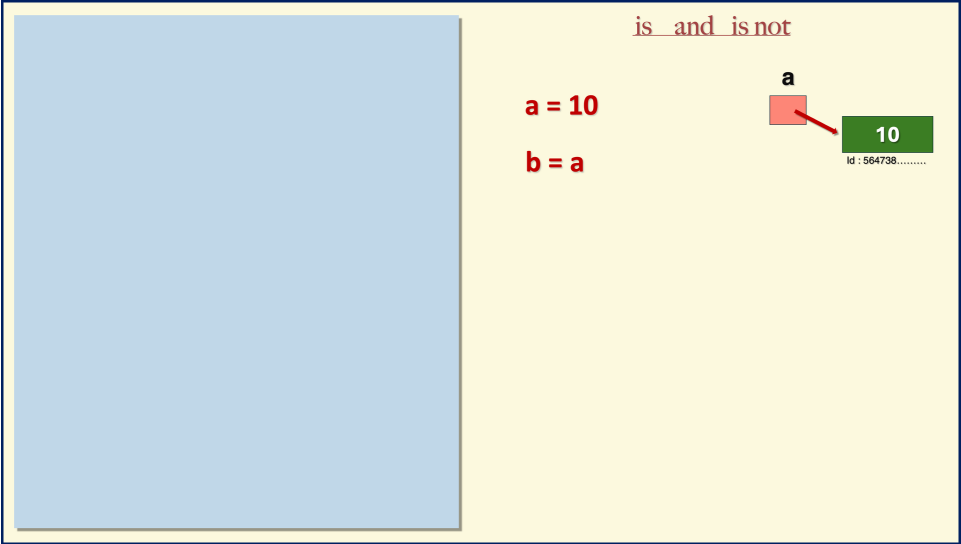
$$a < b \text{ and } b < c$$
$$a < b < c$$

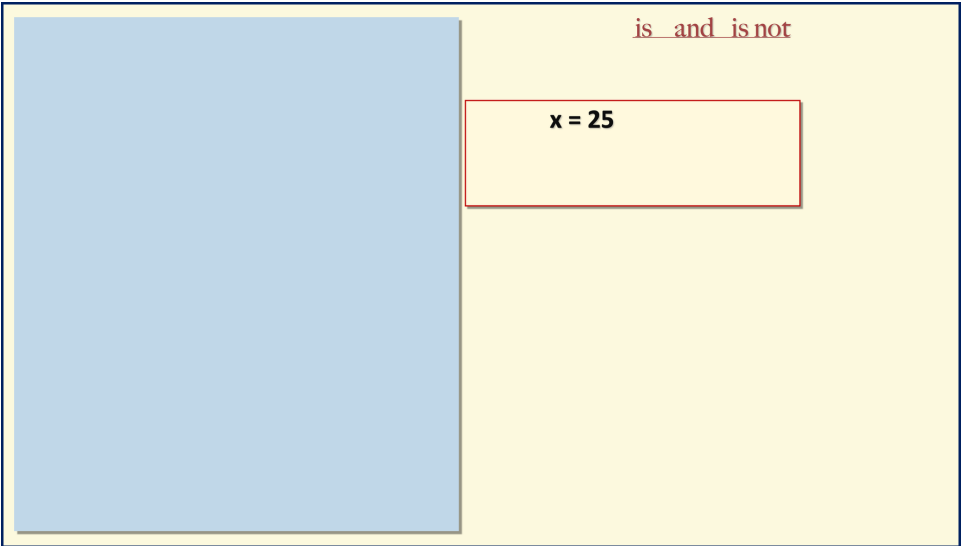
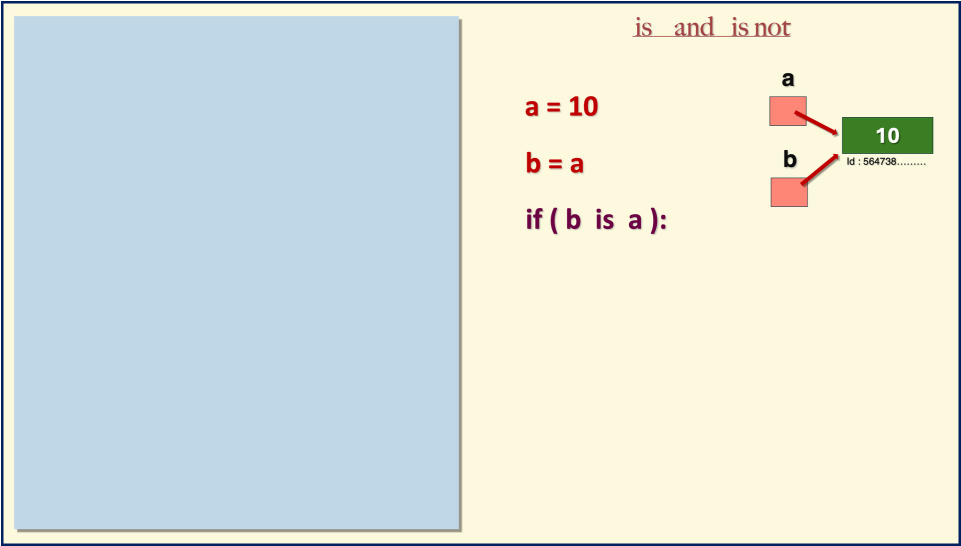
$$a == b \text{ and } b < c$$
$$a == b < c$$

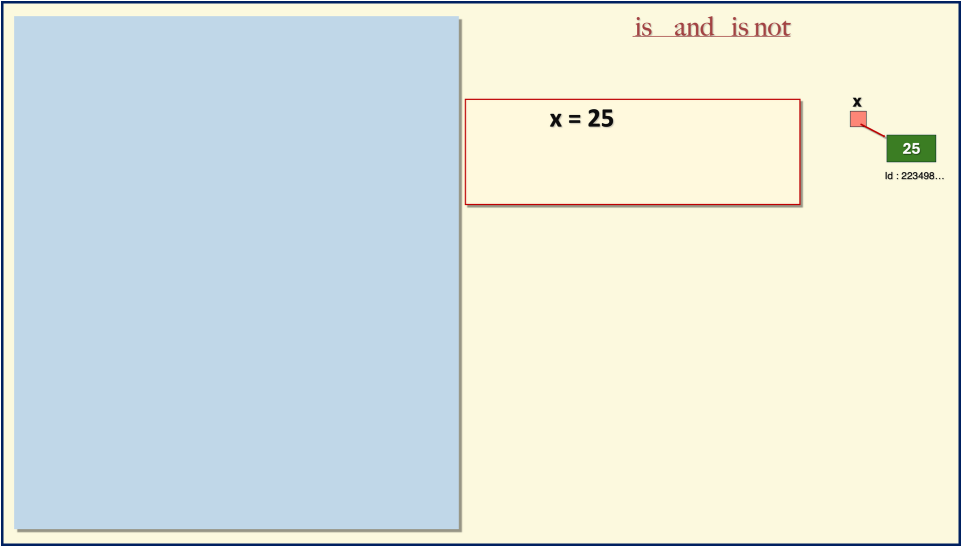
$$a > b \text{ and } b < c \text{ and } c > d$$
$$a > b < c > d$$

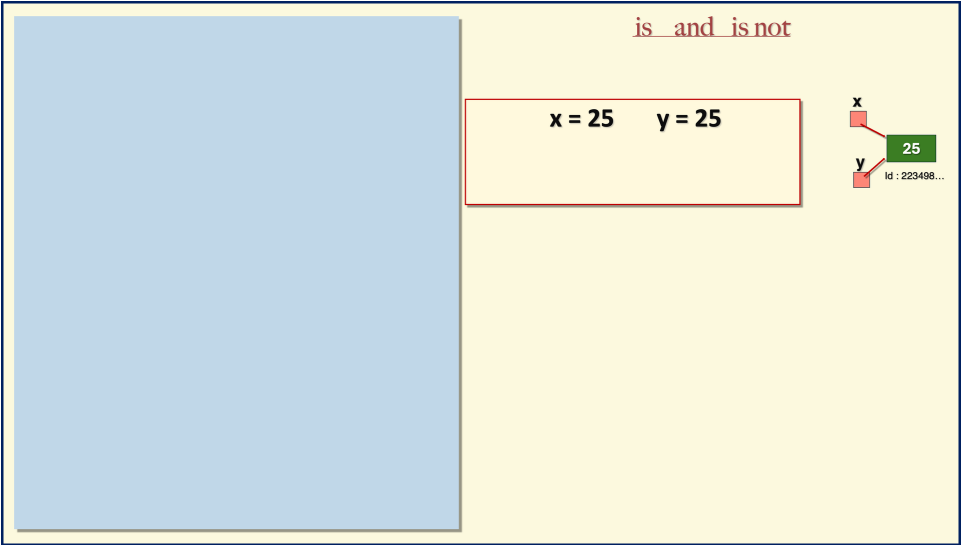
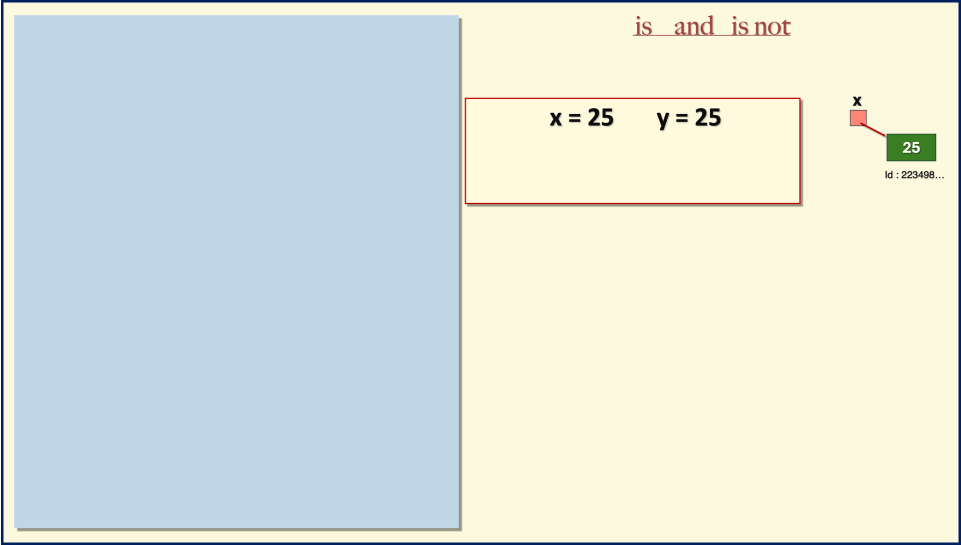


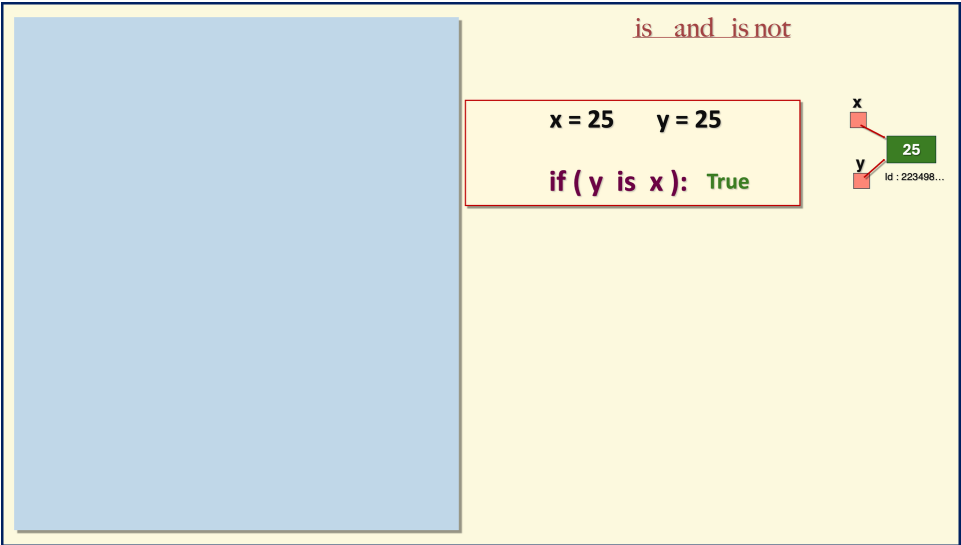
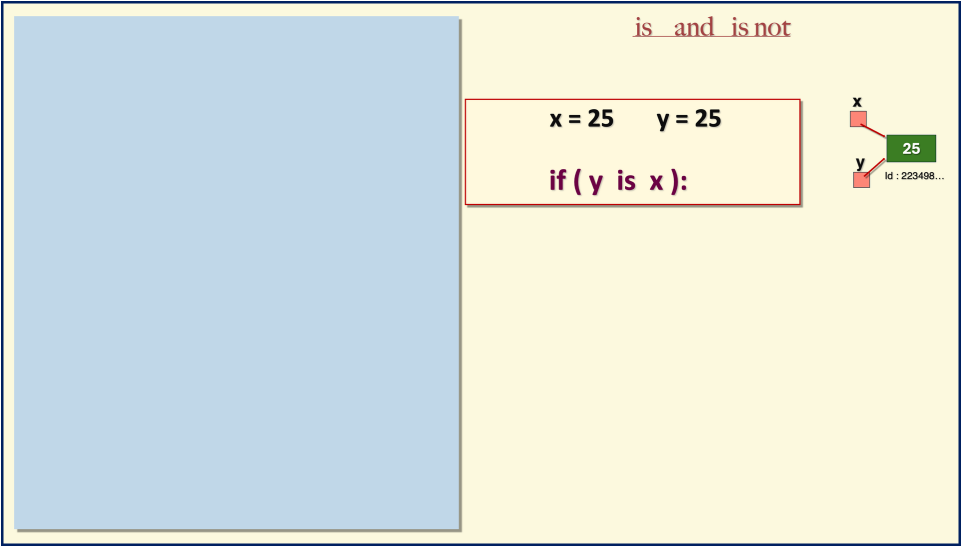


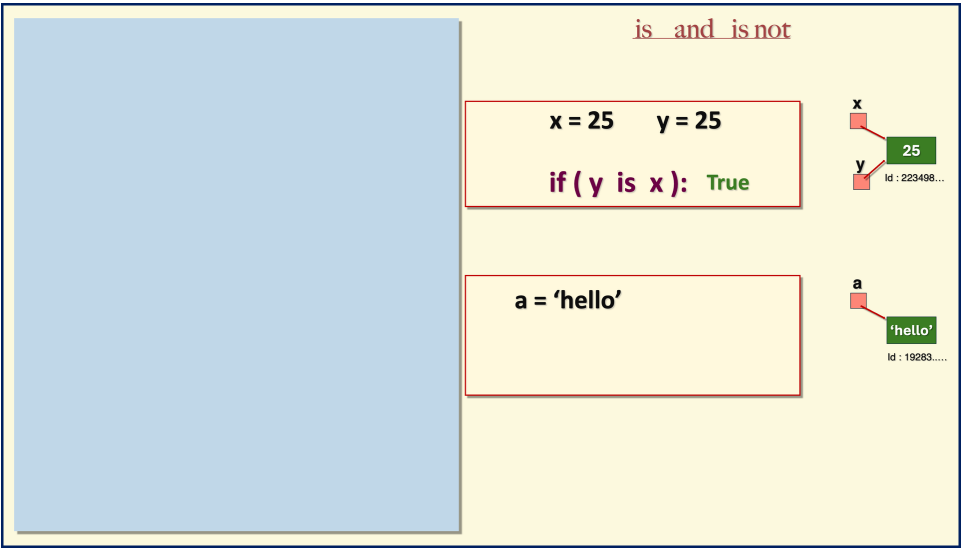
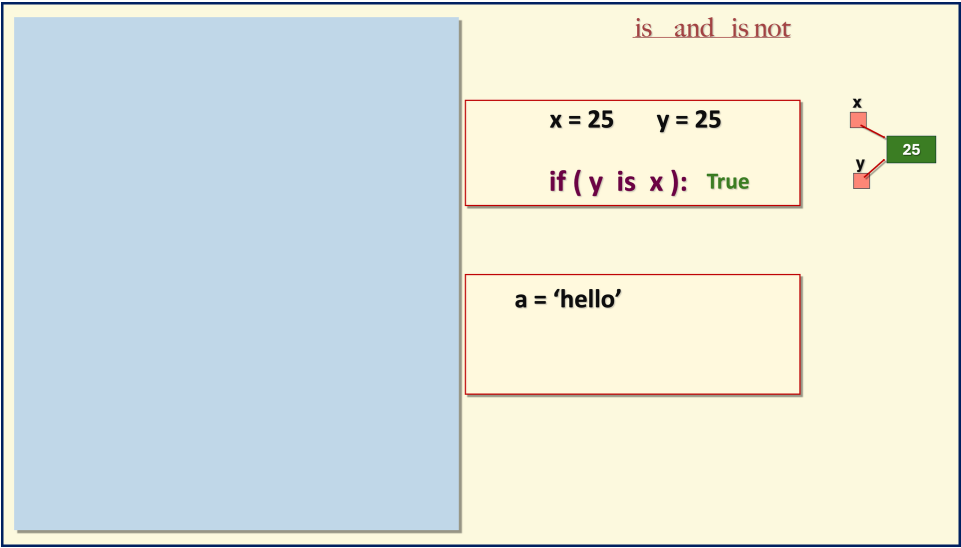


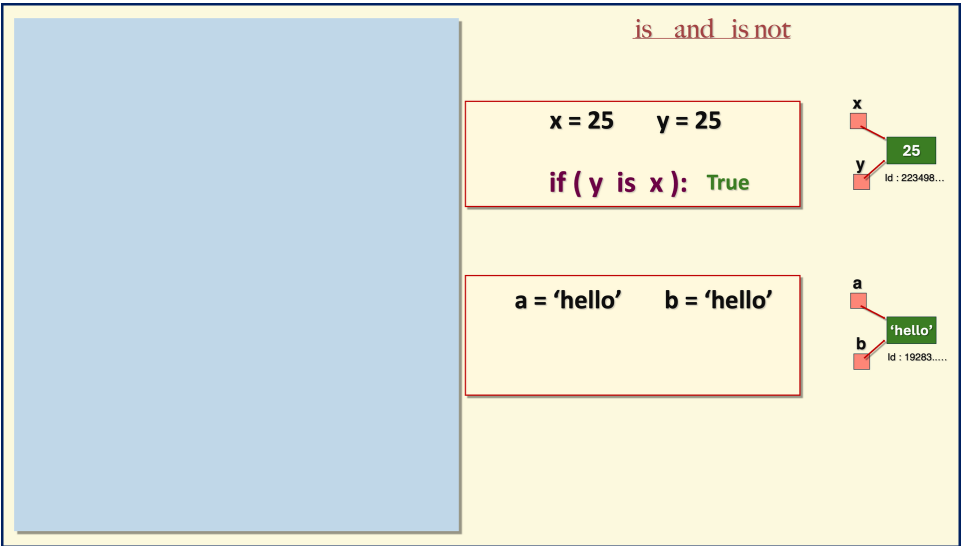
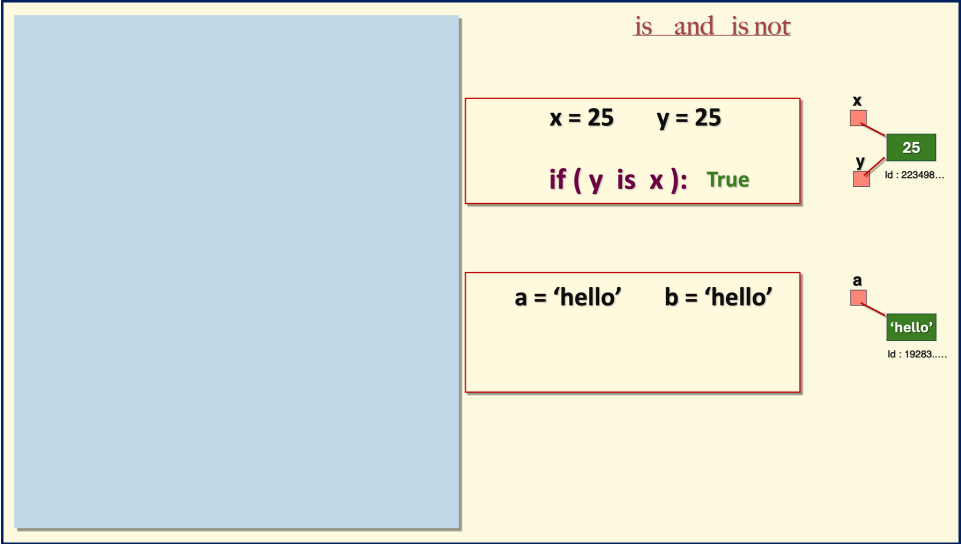


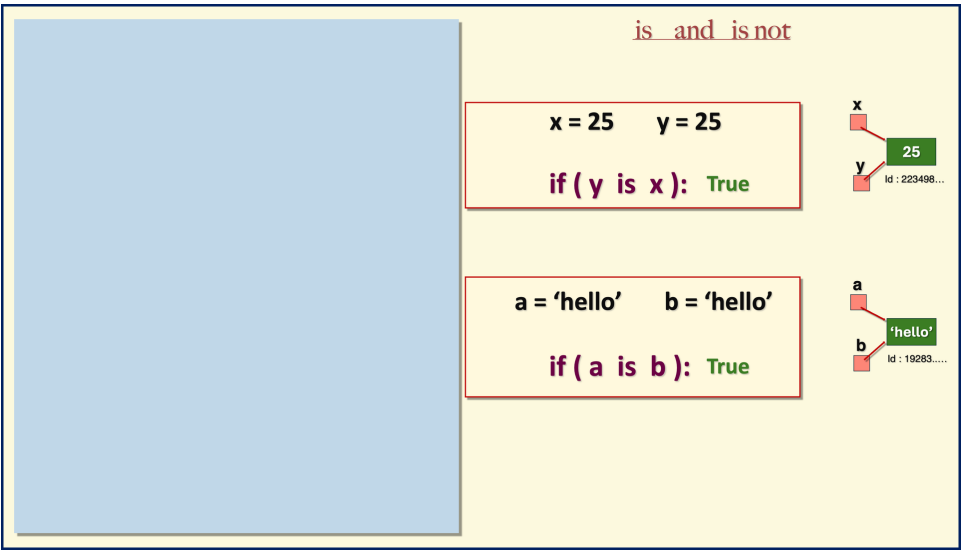
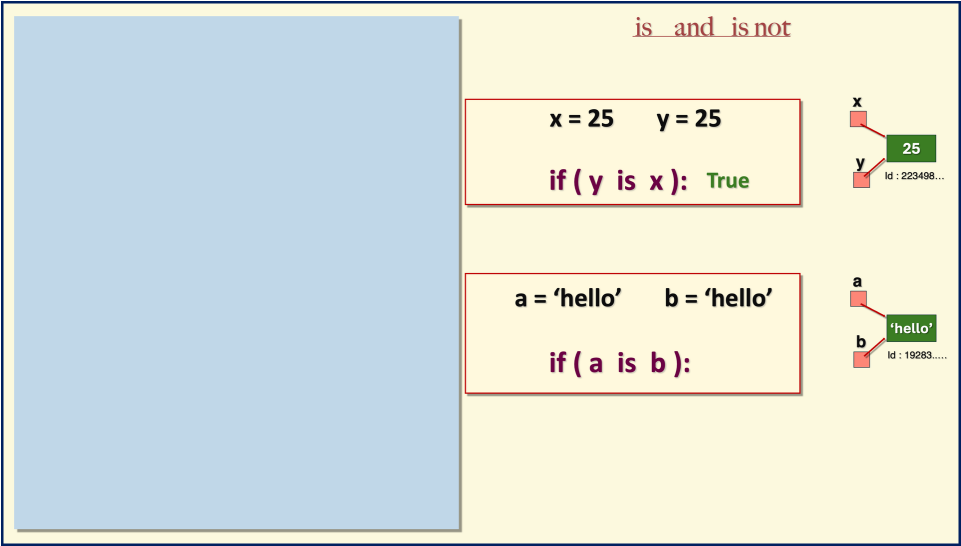












localhost

jupyter PythonPractice

Python 3 (ipykernel)

Logout

File Edit View Insert Cell Kernel Widgets Help

In []:

is and is not

x = 25 y = 25

if (y is x): True

a = 'hello' b = 'hello'

if (a is b): True

x

y

25

Id : 223498.....

a

b

'hello'

Id : 19283.....

localhost

jupyter PythonPractice

Logout

Trusted Python 3 (ipykernel)

File Edit View Insert Cell Kernel Widgets Help

Run Code

In [1]:
a = 'hello'
b = 'hello'
b is a
Out[1]: True
In []:

is and is not

x = 25 y = 25

if (y is x): True

a = 'hello' b = 'hello'

if (a is b): True

x

y

25

Id : 223498...

a

b

'hello'

Id : 19283.....

localhost

jupyter PythonPractice

Logout

Trusted Python 3 (ipykernel)

File Edit View Insert Cell Kernel Widgets Help

Run Code

In [1]:
a = 'hello'
b = 'hello'
b is a
Out[1]: True
In [2]: id(a)
Out[2]: 140436662735472
In []:

is and is not

x = 25 y = 25

if (y is x): True

a = 'hello' b = 'hello'

if (a is b): True

x

y

25

Id : 223498...

a

b

'hello'

Id : 19283.....

localhost

jupyter PythonPractice

Python 3 (ipykernel)

File Edit View Insert Cell Kernel Widgets Help

In [1]:

a = 'hello'
b = 'hello'
b is a

Out[1]: True

In [2]:

id(a)

Out[2]: 140436662735472

In [3]:

id(b)

Out[3]: 140436662735472

In []:

is and is not

x = 25 y = 25

if (y is x): True

a = 'hello' b = 'hello'

if (a is b): True

x

y

25

Id : 223498...

a

b

'hello'

Id : 19283.....